title: "Fire Safety Policy" effectiveDate: "" reviewDate: "" version: "1.0"

Fire Safety Policy

Policy Title: Fire Safety

Effective Date: [Insert Date]

Review Date: [Insert Date – usually annually]

Version: 1.0

Applies to: All staff, contractors, volunteers, visitors, and residents at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME]

1. Policy Statement

At [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], we are committed to protecting the lives of residents, staff, visitors, and contractors by implementing effective fire prevention and response measures.

We aim to:

- Minimise the risk of fire through proactive prevention and risk management.
- Ensure safe and effective evacuation in the event of fire.
- Comply with statutory requirements, including the Regulatory Reform (Fire Safety) Order 2005 and CQC regulations.
- Promote a culture of fire safety awareness, responsibility, and continuous improvement.

2. Purpose

This policy sets out the principles and procedures for fire safety at [INSERT CARE HOME NAME], including:

- Fire risk assessment and prevention measures
- Fire detection, alarm, and firefighting equipment
- Evacuation procedures and resident support (including PEEPs)
- Staff training, drills, and responsibilities
- Reporting and learning from fire incidents

3. Scope

This policy applies to:

- All employees, agency staff, contractors, and volunteers
- Residents and visitors

- All areas of the care home premises

4. Roles and Responsibilities

Registered Manager (Responsible Person):

- Ensures implementation and monitoring of the fire safety policy.
- Oversees fire risk assessments and ensures they are updated annually or after significant changes.
- Reports significant fire incidents to relevant authorities (Fire & Rescue Service, CQC, etc.).
- Ensures staff training, fire drills, and equipment maintenance.

Fire Safety Officer / Appointed Person (if applicable):

- Carries out regular fire safety checks and audits.
- Maintains records of drills, equipment servicing, and training.
- Acts as key contact for fire safety matters.

All Staff:

- Follow fire safety protocols and complete mandatory training.
- Participate in fire drills and know evacuation procedures.
- Report hazards, faulty equipment, or blocked exits immediately.

Residents and Visitors:

- Will be informed of evacuation procedures and supported as required.

5. Key Fire Safety Measures

5.1 Fire Prevention

- No smoking permitted inside the building; designated outdoor areas only.
- Electrical appliances PAT tested annually.
- Fire doors kept closed and never obstructed.
- Combustible materials stored safely.

5.2 Fire Detection and Equipment

- Fire alarms tested weekly.
- Emergency lighting checked monthly.
- Fire extinguishers serviced annually.
- Fire exits clearly signed and unobstructed.
- Sprinkler system (if installed) inspected as required.

5.3 Evacuation Procedures

- Raise the alarm immediately if fire is discovered.
- Call 999 and request the Fire & Rescue Service.
- Assist residents according to their Personal Emergency Evacuation Plans (PEEPs).
- Proceed to the designated assembly point: [INSERT LOCATION].
- Do not re-enter the building until the Fire & Rescue Service confirms it is safe.

6. Fire Drills and Training

- Fire drills held at least twice per year.
- All new staff receive fire safety induction training.

- Annual refresher training for all staff.
- Records of training and drills maintained by the manager.

7. Managing Fire Incidents

- Immediate evacuation following alarm activation.
- Fire wardens check designated areas if safe to do so.
- Incident reported to Registered Manager and documented.
- Post-incident review conducted to identify lessons learned.

8. Staff Health and Responsibilities

- Staff must remain familiar with fire procedures and assembly points.
- Any staff member unable to participate in physical evacuation support must notify management.
- Staff must report hazards or unsafe practices immediately.

9. Monitoring and Audit

- Weekly alarm and fire door checks.
- Monthly emergency lighting and escape route inspections.
- Annual fire risk assessment review.
- Audit findings recorded and acted upon.

10. References

- Regulatory Reform (Fire Safety) Order 2005
- Health and Social Care Act 2008 (Regulated Activities) Regulations 2014
- CQC Fundamental Standards – Regulation 12 (Safe Care and Treatment)
- HM Government Fire Safety in Care Homes (Guide)

11. Related Policies

- Health & Safety Policy
- Risk Assessment Policy
- Emergency Preparedness Policy
- Training & Development Policy
- Resident Personal Emergency Evacuation Plan (PEEP) Policy

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